

SILVER SURFER

Sentinel of the Spaceways

SILVER SURFER

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Norrin Radd

OCCUPATION

Spacefaring adventurer

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT

6 ft 4 in

WEIGHT

225 lbs (variable)

EYES

Silver (blue as Radd)

HAIR

None (black eyebrows as Radd)

FIRST APPEARANCE

Fantastic Four #48

(March 1966)

POWERS

Navigates the galaxy at faster-than-light speeds, riding virtually indestructible board; can channel cosmic energy to augment strength, heal others, and restructure matter.

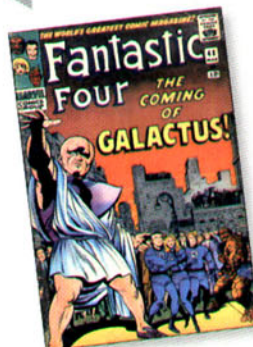
ALLIES/FOES

ALLIES Fantastic Four, Shalla-Bal, Alicia Masters, A-B Harper, the Defenders, Mantis, Nova

Foes Galactus, Mephisto, Loki, Terrax, Yarro Gort, the Abomination, Doomsday Man

ISSUE #1

Pre-warned by Uatu the Watcher, the Fantastic Four stand ready for their first encounter with the herald of Galactus—the Silver Surfer.



Bored and frustrated by life on Zenn-La, Norrin Radd sought a more challenging existence.

world, the Surfer developed a similarly ambivalent relationship with the Earth, where the altruism of so many was sullied by the wanton malice of a few.

THE ZENN-LAVIANS

Born Norrin Radd on the faraway world of Zenn-La, even as a child Norrin was something of an outcast. Wanting for nothing, the Zenn-Lavians were an easy-going people whereas Norrin hungered for a more meaningful, vibrant life. A restless adult, even Norrin's lifelong companion, Shalla-Bal, could not quieten his spirit. It was only when the Zenn-Lavians detected the approach of an alien entity—Galactus, devourer of worlds—that Norrin came into his own.



Galactus imbues Norrin Radd with the Power Cosmic, transforming him into the Silver Surfer.

In exchange for Galactus sparing Zenn-La, Norrin offered to become the entity's herald—to scour the galaxy for planet's devoid of life but suitable for Galactus' needs. To empower Norrin for this role, Galactus plucked an old adolescent fantasy from the young Zenn-Lavian's mind and transformed him into a silver skinned creature who could travel the galaxy on a silver board. Norrin had become the Silver Surfer.

Over the years the Earth has played to host to a variety of extraordinary beings: super-powered heroes and villains, mutants and Norse Gods, but few creatures have been as powerful yet restless as that enigmatic alien entity, the Silver Surfer. A galactic wanderer frustrated by the hedonism and complacency of his own



ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

- **Fantastic Four #48-50** The Silver Surfer and Galactus' first encounter with Earth.
- **Silver Surfer Vol. 1 #1** Stan Lee tells the story of the Silver Surfer's origins in the character's first stand-alone series.
- **Silver Surfer Vol. 2 #1** Returning to Zenn-La the Surfer discovers it has been devastated by the world-devouring Galactus.

HERALD OF GALACTUS

Over time it became increasingly difficult for the Surfer to find appropriate worlds for his master, and so Galactus began to make subtle changes to the Surfer's mind. The Surfer was made to care less about avoiding sentient life, and countless worlds and peoples were sacrificed. Until, that is, he arrived on the planet Earth.

There the Surfer encountered the FANTASTIC FOUR and Alicia MASTERS. Their compassion and heroism reawakened the Surfer's suppressed



His conscience awoken by Alicia Masters, the Silver Surfer stood ready to oppose Galactus for the very first time.

emotions and he aligned himself with them. Threatened with the Ultimate Nullifier, a weapon used by Reed Richards (MR. FANTASTIC), Galactus was driven off, but not before punishing the Silver Surfer for his treachery: Galactus wrapped a field around the Earth designed to prevent the Surfer from ever leaving.

In the years that followed, Galactus returned to Earth several times, wishing to reclaim the Surfer as his herald. Each time the Fantastic Four helped drive him away.

INNOCENCE LOST

The Silver Surfer arrived on Earth as something of an innocent. The malevolent DOCTOR DOOM played on this naivety, befriendng the Surfer and then stealing his powers. When Doom attempted to leave the Earth he ran into Galactus' cosmic barrier, losing control of these powers and enabling the Silver Surfer to regain them.

As the Surfer traveled the world, he became increasingly appalled by mankind's bigotry and cruelty. The Surfer believed he had left behind a stagnant, complacent world only to arrive at one soiled by ambition and greed. Hoping that humanity



LOVE LIFE

Although his heart remains with his first love, Shalla-Bal, during his interstellar voyages, the Silver Surfer has romanced several other women. The most significant of these was Alicia Masters who, during their first encounter, had revived him from his Galactus-induced mental stupor. For a time, Alicia journeyed across the stars with the Surfer, but she eventually decided to return to Earth. Years earlier, the Surfer had been linked to the Celestial Madonna, an Earth-born cosmic heroine, but she died during their battle against the Elders of the Universe. Tragedy also ended his relationship with Nova. A former Herald of Galactus, Nova died battling her successor as herald, the evil Morg.



The Celestial Madonna was also known as Mantis.

would improve if threatened by a common enemy, he transformed himself into mankind's nemesis. Only a "Sonic Shark" missile, created by Reed Richards, ended the threat that he posed.

FREEDOM REGAINED

Essentially exiled to the Earth, the Surfer never stopped yearning to travel amongst the stars once more. With Reed Richards' help he found a way of doing this, but his wanderings were not without upset. Returning to Zenn-La, the Surfer discovered that although his people still survived, Galactus had returned and ravaged the planet. The Surfer's visit to Zenn-La was curtailed when he learnt that his old lover, Shalla-Bal, had been

kidnapped by the demon Mephisto—a creature bent on corrupting the Surfer's soul. Arriving back on Earth, the Surfer freed Shalla-Bal and provided her with some of his own cosmic power—sufficient to heal their home planet.

His exile on Earth over, the Surfer sets out to explore the cosmos.

ROMANCE

In the following years, the Surfer remained an itinerant wanderer, forever searching for fulfilment but never quite finding it. Although he embarked on a series of relationships, these were generally short-lived. A romance with MANTIS, ended in tragedy following a battle with the ELDERS OF THE UNIVERSE, while the Surfer's relationship with NOVA, another herald of Galactus, was similarly doomed.

It was the Surfer's friendship with Alicia Masters that seemed to have the most potential. Striking up a romance, for a time the pair traveled the galaxy together, but eventually Alicia wanted to settle down back on Earth, whereas the Surfer wished to continue his nomadic existence. To this day he remains a galactic wanderer, returning to Earth at regular intervals but remaining sceptical of its long-term prospects. **AD**

As Nova, Frankie Raye was one of Galactus's more recent heralds.



Not the best of friends, the Silver Surfer and Galactus regularly face each other in battle.

